

1. GAME OVERVIEW

- **Objective:** Earn the most points from building majorities and your longest continuous exterior wall.
- **Players / Time:** 2-6 players; about 45-60 minutes.
- **Win:** After final scoring, the highest score wins; tied players share the victory.

2. SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- **A.** Place the building market and scoring board centrally.
- **B.** Each player takes a Lion Fountain start tile, matching marker(s), and a reserve/scoring board.
- **C.** Place each scoring marker at 0. Put all 54 building tiles in the bag.
- **D.** Draw four tiles and fill market spaces 1-4. Each space determines the currency required.
- **E.** Deal money face up to each player until the total reaches 20 or more; then keep those cards hidden.
- **F.** Build the money deck in five piles: scoring card 1 in pile 2 and scoring card 2 in pile 4. Stack piles 5 to 1; reveal four cards.
- **G.** Fewest starting cards goes first; break ties by lowest total value.

3. STRUCTURE OF A TURN

1 TAKE MONEY

Take one face-up card, or several whose total is 5 or less.

2 BUY + PLACE

Pay one market tile in its matching currency. No change. Exact payment grants another action.

3 REDESIGN

Add a reserve tile, remove a tile to reserve, or exchange one tile with reserve.

END TURN

Place purchased tiles, then refill market spaces and money display.

4. TYPICAL TABLE SETUP



Market, money, scoring track, player Alhambras and reserves

1. KEY MECHANICS

- **Money:** Take any one card, or multiple cards totaling no more than 5.
- **Buying:** Use only the currency matching the tile market space. Overpaying is allowed, but no change is given.
- **Exact payment:** Immediately take another full action. Several exact buys can chain.
- **Placement:** A tile must share at least one edge with the existing Alhambra; orientation cannot change after placement.
- **Access:** Every tile must remain reachable from the Lion Fountain without crossing a wall.
- **Walls:** Walls may touch walls; a wall may not touch an open edge. No holes or enclosed empty spaces.
- **Reserve:** Reserved buildings do not count for scoring.
- **Refill:** Do not refill money or market until the active player finishes all actions and placements.

FREQUENTLY FORGOTTEN

- Purchased tiles are placed only at the end of the turn, in any order.
- The Lion Fountain cannot be removed or exchanged.
- A redesign action changes only one tile: add, remove, or exchange.
- During a scoring tie, add the tied ranks and divide points equally, rounding down.

2. SCORING SUMMARY

Building	Score 1	Score 2	Final
Pavilion	1	8 / 1	16 / 8 / 1
Seraglio	2	9 / 2	17 / 9 / 2
Arcades	3	10 / 3	18 / 10 / 3
Chambers	4	11 / 4	19 / 11 / 4
Garden	5	12 / 5	20 / 12 / 5
Tower	6	13 / 6	21 / 13 / 6

- Score building majorities when each scoring card appears and after the game ends.
- Also score 1 point per segment in your longest continuous exterior wall during every scoring round.
- In the 2-player game, the neutral player participates in building majorities but not wall scoring.

4. END OF GAME

- The end begins when the market cannot be fully refilled because the building supply is exhausted.
- Award remaining market tiles to the player holding the highest total in each matching currency. Ties award no tile.
- Players place awarded tiles, then complete final building-majority and wall scoring.
- Highest score wins. Tied players share the victory.

3. STRATEGIC TIPS

- **GOOD HABITS**
- Keep several currencies flexible rather than chasing every visible tile.
- Use exact payment to create high-value action chains.
- Preserve open routes from the fountain and avoid trapping unusable spaces.
- Use the reserve to protect future placement flexibility.
- **COMMON MISTAKES**
- Do not count reserve tiles for building majorities.
- Do not refill the displays between chained exact-payment actions.
- Avoid walls that block access or create an enclosed empty area.
- **COMPETITIVE TIPS**
- Track opponents' counts in high-value Gardens and Towers.
- A modest majority plus a long wall can outperform unfocused expansion.
- Near game end, retain strong totals in currencies matching desirable market tiles.
- Redesign only when the positional gain exceeds a money or purchase action.